

B2

GRAMMAR LESSON · PAST MODALS

Past Possibility: May have / Might have / Could have

may have, might have, could have — maybe it happened, maybe not.

Geçmişe Yönelik Olasılık

QUICK UNDERSTANDING

May have, might have ve could have + V3 yapıları, geçmişte olmuş olabilecek ama kesin bilmediğimiz bir şeyi anlatmak için kullanılır. Şu anda konuşurken o olayın gerçekten olup olmadığından emin değilizdir — sadece bir **tahmin** yapıyoruzdur. Türkçedeki "...mış olabilir" kalıbının İngilizcedeki karşılığıdır.

The Structure

Formula

Özne + may / might / could + have + V3 (past participle)

Olumsuz: may not have / might not have + V3 (could have'in olumsuzu "couldn't have" farklı bir anlam taşır — imkansızlık bildirir, aşağıdaki "Sık Yapılan Hatalar"a bak.)

Affirmative / Negative / Question

AFFIRMATIVE	NEGATIVE	QUESTION
Özne + may/might/could + have + V3 He may have lost his keys.	Özne + may/might + not + have + V3 She might not have heard you.	Do you think + özne + may/might/could + have + V3? Do you think he could have forgotten?

Word Order

Özne — may/might/could — have — V3 (past participle) — (nesne/tümleyen)

- They **might have left** already. — Belki de çoktan gitmişlerdir.
- She **could have called** while I was in the shower. — Ben duştaiken aramış olabilir.

How It Works

When do we use it?

- **Geçmişte gerçekleşmiş olabilecek bir olay hakkında tahmin için:** She might have forgotten our meeting.
- **Elimizde kanıt olan ama kesin sonuca varamadığımız durumlar için:** The lights are off — they may have gone out.
- **Could have, genellikle daha nötr bir olasılığı belirtir:** He could have taken a taxi instead of walking.
- **Olumsuz biçimde bir şeyin olmamış olabileceğini belirtmek için:** She may not have seen your message yet.

When DON'T we use it?

Geçmişe yönelik olasılık için sadece "may/might/could + V3" KULLANMA — mutlaka "have" ile birlikte kullanılmalıdır, aksi halde anlam şimdiki/gelecek zamana kayar.

✗ He may missed the bus. → ✓ He may have missed the bus.

Bunu kesin bir geçmiş olayla (must have ile ifade edilen kesinlikle) KARIŞTIRMA: "must have" neredeyse eminliği, "may/might/could have" ise sadece bir ihtimali anlatır.

Short Answers

Bu yapıda klasik kısa cevap (Yes, I do gibi) kullanılmaz çünkü zaten bir tahmin ifade eder. Onun yerine "Maybe." / "Possibly, yes." / "I doubt it." gibi tahmine dayalı kısa yanıtlar tercih edilir.

Türkçe Mantığı

Zihninde şu sırayla ilerle:

TÜRKÇEDE NE DEMEK İSTİYORUM? → "Otobüsü kaçırmış olabilir." → BU BİR GERÇEK Mİ, YOKSA TAHMİN Mİ?
→ Tahmin, emin değilim → ZAMAN? → Geçmişte olmuş bir olay hakkında şimdiki tahminim → CÜMLE → "He may have missed the bus."

Examples

TEMEL

- He may have taken the wrong train. — Yanlış trene binmiş olabilir.
- She might have forgotten about the appointment. — Randevuyu unutmuş olabilir.
- They could have missed the announcement. — Duyuruyu kaçırmış olabilirler.
- I may have left my umbrella at the office. — Şemsiyemi ofiste unutmuş olabilirim.
- The email might not have arrived yet. — E-posta henüz ulaşmamış olabilir.

ORTA SEVİYE

- Someone could have taken my parking spot by mistake. — Biri yanlışlıkla park yerimi almış olabilir.
- She may have already told him the news. — Ona haberi çoktan vermiş olabilir.
- They might have changed their minds about the trip. — Seyahatle ilgili fikir değiştirmiş olabilirler.
- He could have left the door open by accident. — Kapıyı kazara açık bırakmış olabilir.
- We may not have explained the rules clearly enough. — Kuralları yeterince açık anlatmamış olabiliriz.

KANITA DAYALI TAHMİN

- Look at the broken window — a bird might have flown into it. — Kırık pencereye bak — bir kuş çarpmış olabilir.
- The floor is wet; someone may have spilled some water. — Yer ıslak; biri su dökmüş olabilir.

- Her phone is off — she could have run out of battery. — Telefonu kapalı — pili bitmiş olabilir.
- The plants look dry — nobody may have watered them this week. — Bitkiler kurumuş görünüyor — bu hafta kimse sulamamış olabilir.
- The light was on when we left, so someone might have come back. — Çıktığımızda ışık açıktı, yani biri geri gelmiş olabilir.

Compare & Notice

Compare With

May have / Might have / Could have	Must have
Geçmişte olmuş olabilecek bir şey hakkında tahmin — emin değiliz. He may have lost the ticket.	Elimizdeki kanıtlara dayanarak neredeyse kesin bir sonuç — çok güçlü bir mantıksal çıkarım. He must have lost the ticket — it's not in his bag.

Karar Şeması (Decision Guide)

düşük ihtimal — might have ↔ orta ihtimal — may have / could have ↔ neredeyse kesin — must have

Common Mistakes

✗ He may forgot his phone.	✓ He may have forgotten his phone.
WHY? Türkçede "unutmuş olabilir" derken zihinde tek bir kelime var gibi hissedilir, ama İngilizcede modal'dan sonra mutlaka "have + V3" gelmeli — sadece modal + fiil geçmişi anlatmaz.	
✗ She might have forget to call.	✓ She might have forgotten to call.
WHY? have'den sonra fiilin V3 (past participle) hali gelmelidir, yalın hali değil — "have forget" değil "have forgotten".	
✗ He couldn't have call you — I saw him at the meeting. (kastedilen: belki aramıştır ama emin değilim)	✓ He may not have called you — I'm not sure.
WHY? "couldn't have" imkansızlığı (kesinlikle olmadı) anlatır, sıradan olumsuz olasılık için "may not have / might not have" kullanılır.	
✗ Maybe he has gone home already, I think he may has left.	✓ He may have left already.
WHY? Modal fiillerden (may, might, could) sonra "has/had" değil, her özne için değişmeyen düz "have" gelir.	

Practice

Name: _____

Date: _____

Score: _____ / 21

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. Find the mistake and correct it.

He may ^A forgot ^B his phone. ^C

Correction: _____

2. The lights are off — they _____ gone out.

a) must

b) can have

c) may have

d) may

3. Find the mistake and correct it.

She might have ^A forget ^B to call. ^C

Correction: _____

PART B · PRACTICE

4. She _____ seen your message — she hasn't replied.

a) mustn't have

b) not may have

c) may haven't

d) may not have

5. He could _____ (take) a taxi instead of walking.

6. I'm not sure where I left my keys. I _____ left them in the car.

a) can't have

b) might have

c) must have

d) should have

7. Find the mistake and correct it.

I think he ^A may has left ^B ^C.

Correction: _____

8. Your friend didn't come to class. You don't know why.

What do you say?

a) She can have been ill.

b) She might have been ill.

c) She must be ill yesterday.

d) She might been ill.

9. "He could have taken the wrong bus." What does it mean?

a) Perhaps he took the wrong bus.

b) He must take the right bus.

c) He is able to take a bus.

d) He definitely took the wrong bus.

10. You _____ warned me! Now I'm in trouble.

a) must have

b) can't have

c) may have

d) could have

11. They _____ (not / might / hear) the doorbell.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. I _____ made a mistake in the calculation. Let me check.

- a) must b) may have c) may has d) can't have

13. She _____ gone to the library — she often studies there.

- a) can't have b) mustn't have c) should d) might have

14. The package _____ (may / arrive) while we were out.

15. Find the mistake and correct it.

He couldn't have ^A call ^B you — I saw him at the meeting. ^C

Correction: _____

16. We _____ won if we had played better.

- a) can have b) may c) must have d) could have

17. A friend is late. She's never late.

What do you say?

- a) She may has got stuck in traffic.
b) She may have got stuck in traffic.
c) She may got stuck in traffic.
d) She must stuck in traffic.

18. Which sentence shows the strongest certainty?

- a) He could have left. b) He must have left. c) He might have left. d) He may have left.

19. It _____ been Ahmet on the phone — I didn't recognise the voice.

- a) might have b) mustn't have c) must have d) can't have

20. Which sentence is correct?

- a) She may not have received the invitation.
b) She may have not receive the invitation.
c) She mayn't have receive the invitation.
d) She may not received the invitation.

21. Rewrite with "might have": "Perhaps they missed the train."

They _____ the train.

Answer Key

Kısa açıklamalar, her cevabın hangi kurala dayandığını gösterir.

PART A · QUICK CHECK

1. B — **forgot** → **have forgotten** — may have + V3.
2. c) **may have** — Belirsiz geçmiş olasılık → may have.
3. B — **forget** → **forgot** — might have + V3.

PART B · PRACTICE

4. d) **may not have** — Olumsuz olasılık → may not have + V3.
5. **have taken** — could have + V3.
6. b) **might have** — Belirsiz → might have.
7. B — **may has left** → **may have left** — may + have.
8. b) **She might have been ill.** — Belirsiz olasılık → might have been.
9. a) **Perhaps he took the wrong bus.** — could have + V3 → olasılık.
10. d) **could have** — Yapılabilirdi ama yapılmadı → could have (sitem).
11. **might not have heard** — might not have + V3.

PART C · FINAL CHECK

12. b) **may have** — Belirsiz → may have.
13. d) **might have** — Olasılık → might have.
14. **may have arrived** — may have + V3.
15. B — **call** → **called** — couldn't have + V3.
16. d) **could have** — Olası ama gerçekleşmemiş sonuç → could have.
17. b) **She may have got stuck in traffic.** — may have + V3.
18. b) **He must have left.** — must have > may/might/could have.
19. a) **might have** — Emin değil → might have been.
20. a) **She may not have received the invitation.** — may not have + V3.
21. **They might have missed the train.** — might have + V3.

Bu dersin interaktif versiyonu (anında geri bildirimli alıştırma):
<https://abonlinenglish.school/grammar/b2/past-possibility>